quickly as possible and try to inject momentum, going for everything, and hopefully getting our total to around 350, out of reach.

There are 69 deliveries left to be bowled.

Jerome Taylor runs in and bowls ... a slower ball ... straight and full ... there to be hit. My drive is not perfectly timed, but it flies past mid-on and away to the boundary. That feels good. Sometimes in this complex game, for no apparent reason, everything just feels right. That imperfect shot feels right, no question.

The second ball is sliced, driven square for two, and the third is stunned down to third man for one, so I retain the strike for the 40th over, to be bowled by Andre Russell. I push a single to cover off the first ball and Hash takes a single off the second. Maybe this is the moment to accelerate.

FOUR, clubbed over mid-off, one bounce to the boundary ... SIX, moving outside off, pulled over square leg and into the crowd ... FOUR, a straight ball driven over extra cover, two bounces to the boundary ... SIX, improvising, flicking over square leg, crouching on my right knee, losing balance but managing to get the ball away.

The scoreboard shows I've reached 28 from eight balls. Everything feels right. I don't normally play like this so early in an innings, but I feel I'm in a good place today. I'm not premeditating the shot. Before the ball is bowled, I look around, check the fielders, see the space and decide where I'm going to try to hit the ball. That usually leaves me with three or four shot options, and I pick one when I see the length.

So, for example, if I've decided to hit the ball on the leg side, I'll skip outside off, so a full delivery can be driven and a short ball can be pulled over mid-wicket; for anything pitched in between, I'll drop down on one knee and use my go-to lap shot, a flick over square leg, helping it on its way. That's the plan. It doesn't always work.

Taylor is back, and Hash glances a single from the first ball. As I look around the field, I see mid-off has been brought up to be one of the